

Simplifying Expressions

Like Terms • Distributive Property

1

Combine like terms

Like terms share the same variable and exponent.

$$3x + 5 + 2x = 5x + 5$$

Red: x-terms • Amber: constant

Constant
term



Add or subtract the coefficients of like terms.

2

Distributive property

Multiply the outside term by each term inside the parentheses.

$$a(b + c) = ab + ac$$

$$3(x + 4) = 3x + 12$$



Distribute to each term inside the parentheses.



You can only combine terms that are truly alike.

Simplifying Expressions

Like Terms • Distributive Property

1

Combine like terms

Like terms share the same variable and exponent.

$$3x + 5 + 2x = 5x + 5$$

Red: x-terms • Amber: constant

Constant
term



Add or subtract the coefficients of like terms.

2

Distributive property

Multiply the outside term by each term inside the parentheses.

$$a(b + c) = ab + ac$$

$$3(x + 4) = 3x + 12$$



Distribute to each term inside the parentheses.



You can only combine terms that are truly alike.